

Google Ads + Local Services Ads (LSA) — How to give Adverton access

What this is for: to run paid ads on Google for you — Search ads AND the green-checkmark Local Services Ads — Adverton needs Manager access to your Google Ads account, plus your verification documents for LSA.

Time required: - Granting access: 3 minutes. - LSA verification (one-time): 15–20 minutes to upload documents, 3–7 days for Google to review.

What you'll need: - The Google email you'll use for ads (can be the same one as your Google Business Profile). - For LSA: business license, general liability insurance certificate, and willingness to consent to a background check.

Part 1 — Granting access to Google Ads

Path A — You already have a Google Ads account

Step 1 — Adverton sends you an invite

We send a link from inside our Manager Account ("MCC") to the Google email connected to your Ads account. Subject line: *"Adverton would like to manage your Google Ads account"*.

Step 2 — Accept the invite

Open the email, click **Accept request**. You'll be redirected to ads.google.com — sign in if asked.

Step 3 — Confirm

Google shows: *"Adverton (Customer ID XXX-XXX-XXXX) is now linked."* Reply to our email confirming you accepted.

Important: when Google asks if you want to grant "Admin" or "Standard" — choose **Admin**. We need to set bid strategies, budgets, and conversion tracking.

Path B — You don't have a Google Ads account yet

We'll create one for you. The process: 1. We set up the account using your business email (you give it to us during onboarding). 2. Google emails you to confirm a payment method — **enter your business credit card directly with Google**. Adverton never sees your card. You pay Google directly. 3. Once the card is on file, we link the account to our Manager and start building campaigns.

Why you pay Google directly, not us: transparency. You see every dollar of ad spend on your own Google invoice. We never mark up media. Our \$799/mo covers our work; ad spend is separate.

Part 2 — LSA verification (the one with the green Google Guaranteed checkmark)

LSA is the **single highest-leverage ad channel** for home services — and the one that makes the phone ring fastest. Google requires every contractor to pass verification before LSA can run. **You can't skip it.**

What Google requires

Document	What it is	Where to get it
Business license	Your trade license (HVAC, plumbing, electrical, etc.) issued by your state	You should already have it; scan or photo is fine
General Liability insurance	Certificate of insurance (COI), \$1M minimum	Your insurance broker can email it in 24 hours
Background check	Google partners with a third party (Pinkerton or similar) to run a criminal background check on the business owner	Done online — Google emails the link
Workers' comp (some trades + states)	If you have employees, may be required	Your insurance broker

Steps

Step 1 — Adverton enrolls your business in LSA

We do this from your Google Ads account once we have access (Part 1 above).

Step 2 — Google emails you the verification links

You'll receive 1–3 emails from Google ("Local Services by Google") with links to upload documents and start the background check.

Step 3 — Upload your documents

Click each link. Upload license + insurance as PDF or photo. Each upload takes ~2 minutes.

Step 4 — Complete the background check

Click the background-check link. You'll be redirected to a third-party site. Enter your business + owner info, consent to the check. Takes 5 minutes; results come back in 3–7 days.

Step 5 — Wait for "Google Guaranteed" approval

Google reviews everything (3–7 business days). You'll get an email: "*Your business is now Google Guaranteed.*" Forward it to us — that's our trigger to turn LSA on.

What if you fail verification? Rare, but happens with: expired license, lapsed insurance, or unresolved liens against the business. We help you fix and re-submit. The whole thing rarely takes more than 2 weeks even with hiccups.

What happens next

Once Google Ads access + LSA approval are in place: - **Week 1–2:** we build the first Search campaign (keywords, geo-targeting, ad copy) and turn on LSA bidding. - **Week 2–3:** the phone starts ringing. You answer leads; we adjust bids based on what's working. - **Monthly report:** every 1st of the month, you get a plain-English breakdown — calls per channel, cost per qualified lead, what we're changing next month.

Common issues

"I got the Google background-check email but it looks like spam." Sender is usually `noreply-localservices@google.com` or a partner like `pinkerton.com`. Check your spam folder. Forward to us if you're unsure — we'll confirm legitimate before you click.

"My insurance certificate doesn't have the dollar amount Google wants." Email your insurance broker: "*Please issue a COI showing \$1M general liability. Bill-to: [your business name].*" They'll email a new one in 1 business day, no extra cost.

"I share an Ads account with my old agency — can I still grant access to Adverton?" Yes. Google Ads supports multiple Managers. We'll be added in parallel. Once you fully transition off the old agency, you remove them — same Managers screen.

"How do I know Adverton isn't running up my ad spend?" You set the daily budget — Google enforces it hard. You can also log into Google Ads anytime and see live spend. We never pay Google on your behalf — Google bills your card directly, and you see every dollar.

Questions: support@adverton.net